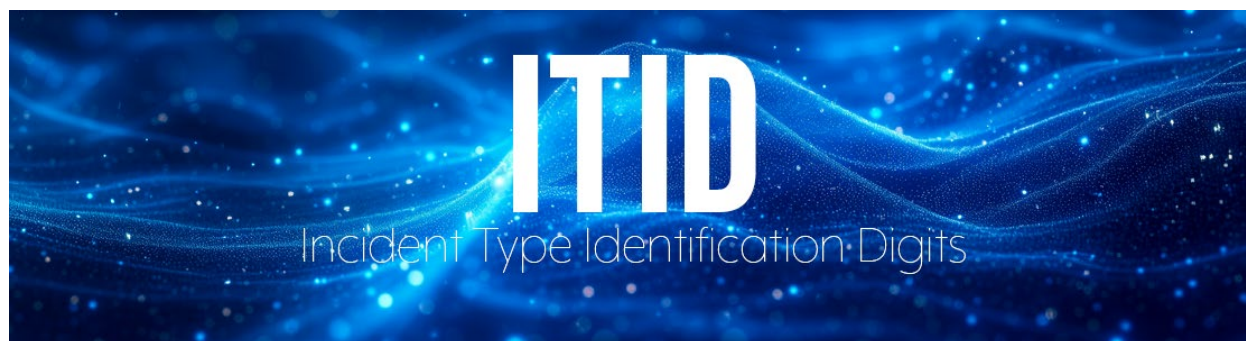




SCOUT: Security Cyber Operations Unified Tracker



CIPHER: Cyber Intelligence Playbooks, Hunting, Enrichment, and Reporting



ITID: Incident Type Identification Digits

Installation Guide

Version 1.1

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Introduction

Welcome to Security Cyber Operations Unified Tracker (SCOUT) and Cyber Intelligence Playbooks, Hunting, Enrichment, and Reporting (CIPHER)! This document is intended to provide you with all of the information you need to get started with and use the SCOUT and CIPHER software effectively.

What is SCOUT?



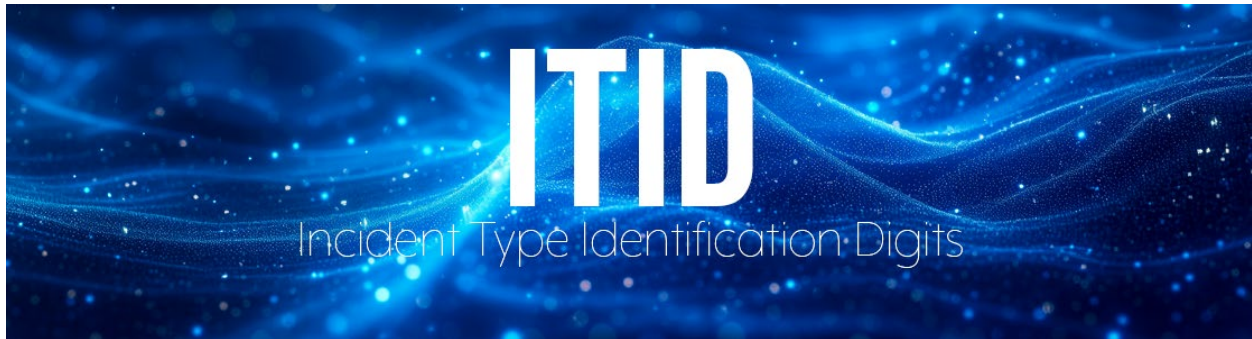
SCOUT is a centralized operations platform designed to provide rapid access to monitoring and tracking tools, operational workflows, and supporting resources. It serves as a single launch point for day-to-day operational activities, incident response, and situational awareness.

What is CIPHER?



CIPHER is a personal knowledge management system for tracking cyber threat intelligence observables. From threat actors to malware to TTPs and IOCs, CIPHER provides a self-contained environment to interact with observables.

What are ITIDs?



ITIDs (Incident Type Identification Digits) is a structured taxonomy of incident type definitions. By standardizing on a common taxonomy, you unlock not only a more regimented security operations center, but also the ability to provide roll-up and enhanced reporting to a wider variety of stakeholders. Furthermore, with SCOUT and CIPHER, the analyst can begin to correlate seemingly hard to reach entities for a wider perspective on the elements that affect your SOC Operations.

System Requirements

Before installing SCOUT and CIPHER, please make sure your computer meets the following requirements:

- Operating System: Windows 64-bit, Mac OSX, and Linux
- Processor: 3.2GHz or higher i7 or above
- RAM: 2GB of RAM
- Hard Disk Space: 10GB or more

General Installation and Configuration Steps:

1. Download and install Obsidian from <https://obsidian.md/download/>
2. Clone the repo from GitHub at <https://github.com/kcyerrid/SCOUT>.
3. Create a new Obsidian Vault.
4. Download and configure community plugins for Obsidian.
5. Download and install the SCOUT content and scaffolding.
6. Configure the config.json file to specify paths, parameters, and elements.

Installing and Configuring SCOUT

The footprint of the SCOUT application is relatively small and simplistic in nature. It consists of the following steps:

1. Download and install Obsidian from their official site.
2. Clone the GitHub repo.
3. Open the vault from the GitHub repo in Obsidian.
4. Install Python Dependencies
5. Run the config_rss.py init command to create a SQLite database
6. Run the SCOUT_SetupWizard.py program and configure preferences.
7. Run SCOUT_Launcher.py and start using the tool.

Installing Obsidian

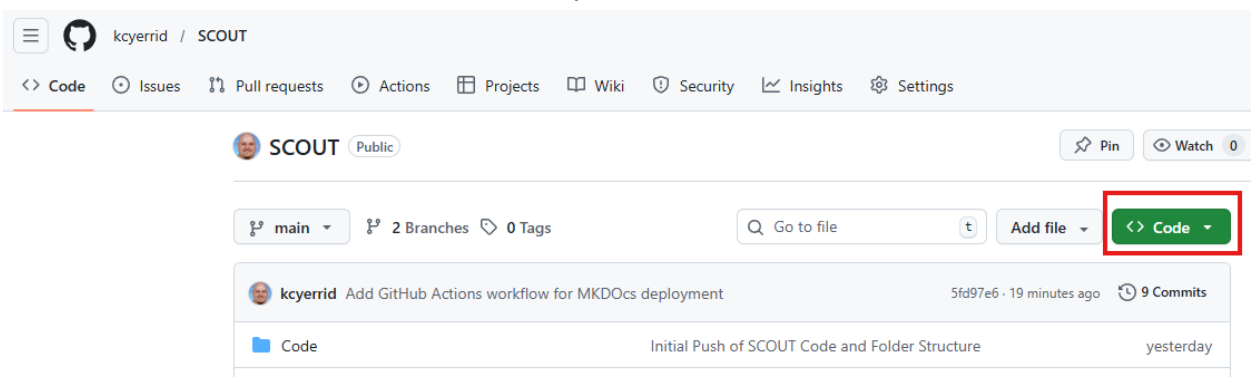
The very first step in the installation of the SCOUT application is the installation and initial setup of the Obsidian environment.

1. Navigate to <https://www.obsidian.md/download> and pull down the latest generally available edition.
2. Run the setup program, taking note as to where you are installing the Obsidian application, **as you will need to locate the executable during the configuration later**. By default, the application is installed in your AppData/Local/Programs/Obsidian folder.

Clone the repo from GitHub

Using HTTPS

1. Navigate to <https://github.com/kcyerrid/SCOUT>
2. Select the <> Code Green Button at the top of the screen

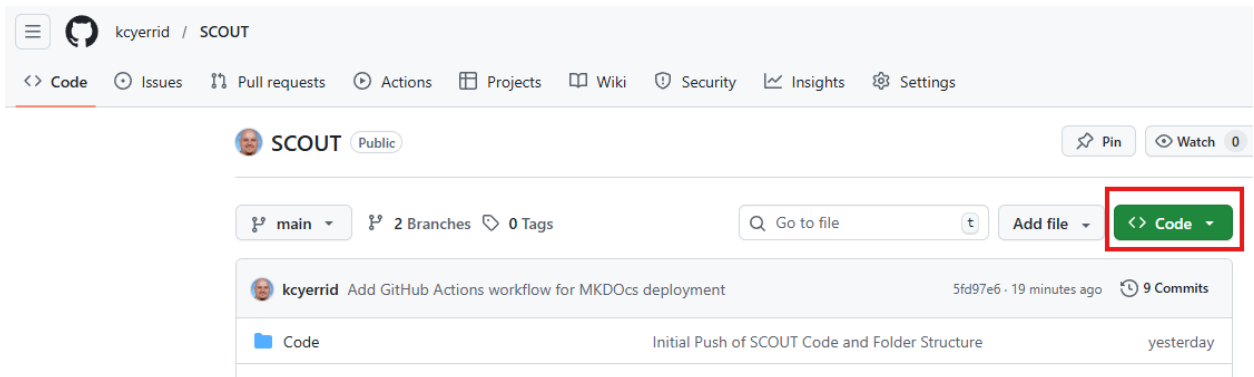


3. Copy the repository URL to your clipboard.

4. Open a terminal window / command prompt to the folder that you want SCOUT to be installed in.
5. Type `git clone https://github.com/kcyerrid/SCOUT` and press enter.

Using SSH

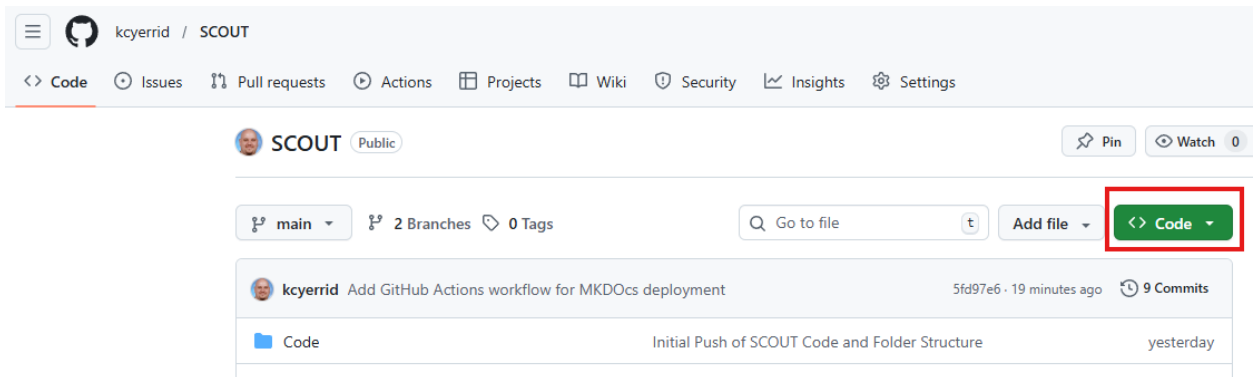
1. Navigate to <https://github.com/kcyerrid/SCOUT>
2. Select the <> Code Green Button at the top of the screen



3. Copy the repository URL under the SSH tab to your clipboard.
4. Open a terminal window / command prompt to the folder that you want SCOUT to be installed in.
5. Type `git clone git@github.com:kcyerrid/SCOUT.git` and press enter.

Using GitHub CLI

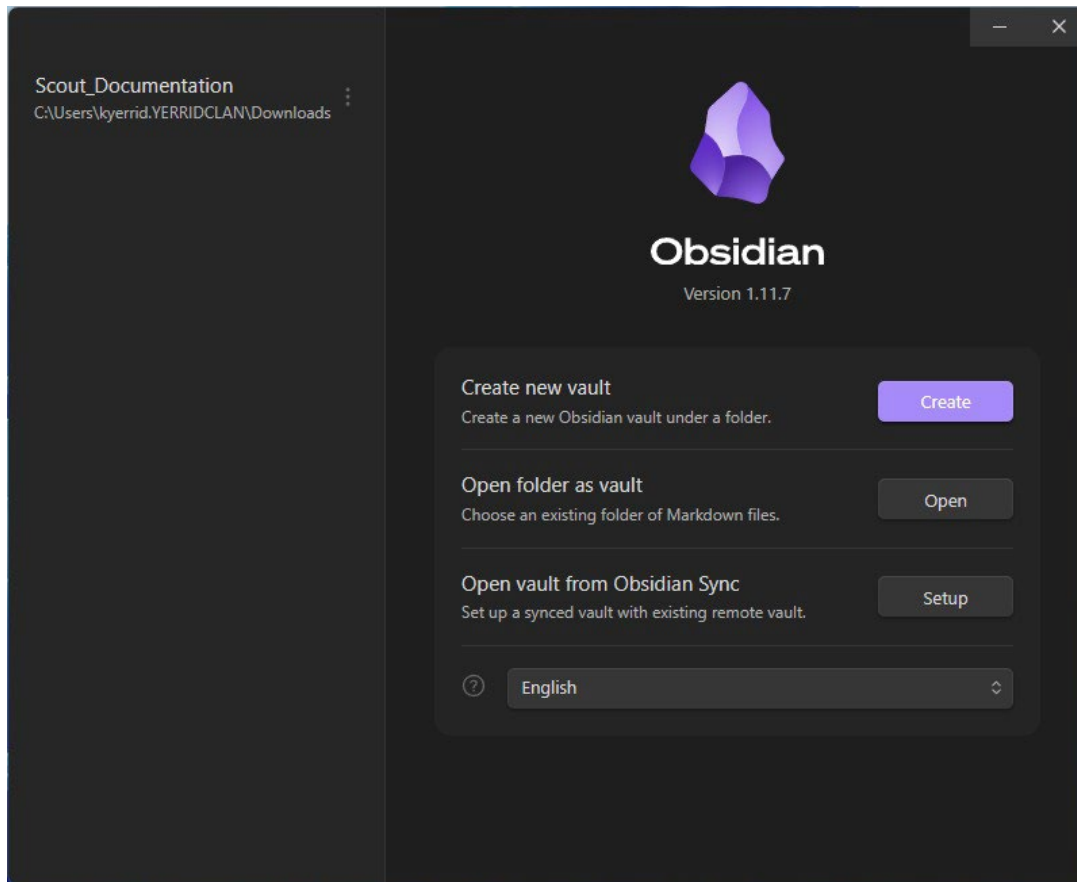
1. Navigate to <https://github.com/kcyerrid/SCOUT>
2. Select the <> Code Green Button at the top of the screen



3. Copy the repository URL under the GitHub CLI tab to your clipboard.
4. Open a terminal window / command prompt to the folder that you want SCOUT to be installed in.
5. Type `gh repo clone kcyerrid/SCOUT` and hit enter.

Open the SCOUT Obsidian Vault

1. When you first launch Obsidian, you will be presented with the initial splash screen where you will choose to open folder as vault



2. Select the SCOUT-FINAL folder in your cloned GitHub folder.
3. Obsidian will ask if you trust the developer and want to enable the plugins. Say Yes
4. Obsidian will begin indexing the notes in the vault, including the starter pack of threat actors and TTPs. This can take a hot minute.

Install Python and the Dependencies

1. Navigate to the Python download website, located at <https://www.python.org/downloads/windows/>
2. Follow the directions to install Python on your computer.

Installing Python Dependencies

From a command line, run `pip install Pillow requests readability-lxml beautifulsoup4 tkinterdnd2 tkcalendar python-pptx`

Run SCOUT_rss.py to Initialize the SQLiteDB

Initializing the RSS Database

1. From a command line, type `python <path.to.app>\scout_rss.py init`

```
C:\Users\kyerrid>python c:\SCOUT\Code\scout_rss.py init
[OK] Initialized DB at: C:\SCOUT\Code\data\rss_news.db
[OK] Feeds synced from config.json

C:\Users\kyerrid>
```

2. After the initialization script has completed, run the same command with a collect parameter instead of init.

```
C:\Users\kyerrid>python c:\SCOUT\Code\scout_rss.py collect
```

Run SCOUT_SetupWizard.py

1. From a command line, type `python <path.to.app>\SCOUT_SetupWizard.py`

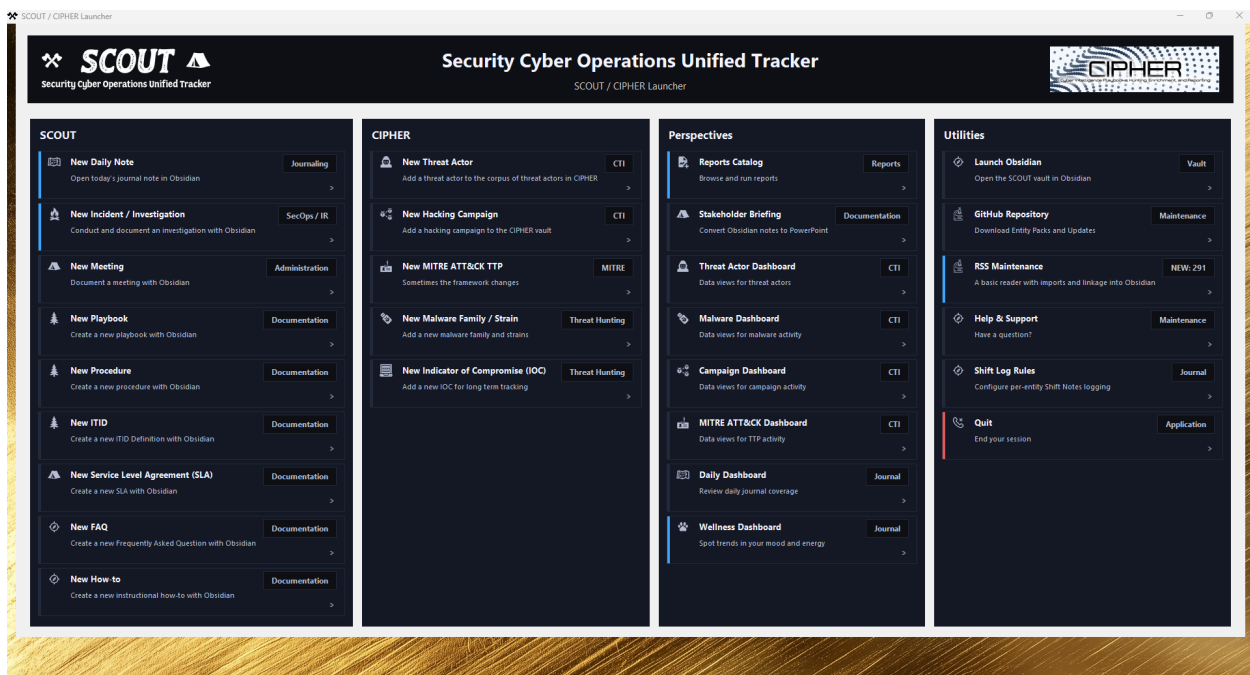
```
C:\Users\kyerrid>python c:\SCOUT\Code\SCOUT_SetupWizard.py
```

2. In the SCOUT Setup Wizard, you will have an opportunity to set all of the key parameters of the application from a central interface.
3. The first screen presented is the Paths & Vault Screen. Here, you will set all of the pointers to the important components of SCOUT, such as the Obsidian vault, and the RSS database. The following values should be checked and set as appropriate:
 - **SCOUT_ROOT, CIPHER_ROOT, VAULT_ROOT:** The path where the .obsidian folder resides.
 - **DAILY_NOTES_DIR:** This should be left to the default value.
 - **OBSIDIAN_EXE:** This should be the correct path to the obsidian.exe executable on your device.
 - **OBSIDIAN_VAULT:** The name of the vault you opened (SCOUT-FINAL).
 - **DAILY_NOTES_REL:** This should be the correct path to your daily notes dumping spot.
 - **RSS_DB:** This is the path to the RSS Database you created in the previous step. The rss_news.db file should be under the Code\data folder in the directory you cloned the repo into.
4. On the second screen, you can configure parameters affecting the application look and feel and positioning on the screen.
5. On the third screen, you can configure information regarding the Daily Note.
6. On this screen, you can configure a connection to a LLM using your API Key.

7. Personalize your SCOUT experience by pre-populating your information.
8. Update the name and subtitle text of the application.
9. Build and adjust the menu of the launcher.
10. After setting the various options, click save to make a backup of the `config.json` file and write the settings.

Launching SCOUT for the First Time

With the application largely configured for use, we can now turn our attention to launching the app through the SCOUT_Launcher. To do so, from a command line, type `python <path.to.app>\Code\SCOUT_Launcher.py`. You will be presented with the launcher as follows:



Congratulations! SCOUT is now installed and ready for further tuning and customization.